

BEATLESSHOPLIVEREDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're in the heart of Liverpool in the UK and I have a very special guest Stephen Bailey and Stephen runs the Beatles shop here in the heart of Liverpool. Stephen, welcome to the program. Nice to meet you.

Now Stephen, this shop is iconic. I'm just looking around. You've got Beatles everything here.

Some of the greatest memorabilia and things people can get from anywhere. Yeah, I mean we try and stock basically an awful lot of stuff. I mean we have original memorabilia and there's modern stuff as well these days, which is produced in quantity.

Yes. Yeah, yeah. I mean I'm looking here.

Just here you've got mugs, you've got socks, you've got ice cubes all sorts of stuff. If you can find something to put Beatles on, they will do. Now you get all sorts of visitors here.

Tell us about some of the people who come into the shop. We get, I mean it is all four corners of the earth basically from where we get visitors. So, yeah, it's a very multicultural shop at times and we could do with speaking a million and one languages.

However, I only speak Scouse. Yeah, we sound like a bit of a Scouser, which is fair enough because we are in the heart of Liverpool and the thing is that I suppose you get musicians and have you had any of the boys come in? Paul or whatever? Well, just behind you there's a photograph of Ringo Starr in the shop. He was visited here in 1982.

We've had Sean Lennon in as well. Gerry and the Pacemakers, members of The Russells, the greatest band that there ever was. Klaus Norman who designed artwork for them.

Yes, we've had a few famous people in over the times. Well, that's incredible and I suppose when people come in here they're just blown away by the variety of stuff you have. I see books from John Lennon.

I see all sorts of things and tell us about the street you're on. You're right around the corner from the Cavern basically. Yeah, we're literally just down the road from the Cavern Club.

Matthew Street is a very busy and vibrant street of a weekend. You know, it's a great place to be and come and visit and it's right at the heart of Liverpool. Do you ever have people coming in and saying, I've got a piece of memorabilia here that you might be interested in? Yeah, we quite often get people coming in with bits of memorabilia from the time.

And it's always wonderful to see and sometimes you go, yes, your bit of memorabilia is worth a small fortune. And unfortunately sometimes we go, sadly your bit of memorabilia is not worth very much at all. More than they're not worth very much at all than worth a small fortune.

You know, you're surprised every day of the week by what comes in. Well, I'll give you a bit of my own memorabilia because in 1964 I was in Vauxhall Primary School and some people came to the school and picked some kids to appear in a little movie running around Marley O'Bone train station. And I was one of those kids in the movie.

It was about 200 of us and they gave us banana and sugar sandwiches for lunch and that was our payment. Well, if you kept a banana and sugar sandwich that you'd been given for lunch, it would be worth a small fortune these days. Exactly.

Well, we thought it was heaven. We thought, wow, free banana and sugar sandwiches. Brilliant.

We didn't have to sign any forms or anything. It was absolutely brilliant. And is there any other little stories you might have for us and interesting things that people, you know, have told you about the Beatles here? It's bizarre.

I mean, we had a person who went around back in the 60s and collected little bits of privet off each of their hedges that they had homes in and stuck them all in a scrapbook. We had a lady in who'd visited, was it George's house, sort of thing, and took some toilet roll out and put that in a scrapbook as well at the time. You know, you have people in who've been to see them in concerts from the time and they are wonderful to meet all those sorts of people.

Now, Stephen, how can people find out more about the Beatles shop online? Well, you can visit us at our Facebook page, which is at Original Beatles Shop, or we have an auction once a year as part of the Beatles Convention and you can visit the page which is www.beatlesauction.co.uk. Great, and I suppose on the Facebook page people can see all sorts of great stuff, you know, and maybe order some things from you from across the world as well. Yeah, we've got sort of Beatles news up there and sort of stuff that we sell in the shop, yeah. Yeah, that's true.

But thank you very much for being with us, Stephen, and the Beatles shop here in Liverpool, a great place to come and visit. Even if you don't buy anything, just coming in, it's a huge museum on its own. Yes, thank you very much.